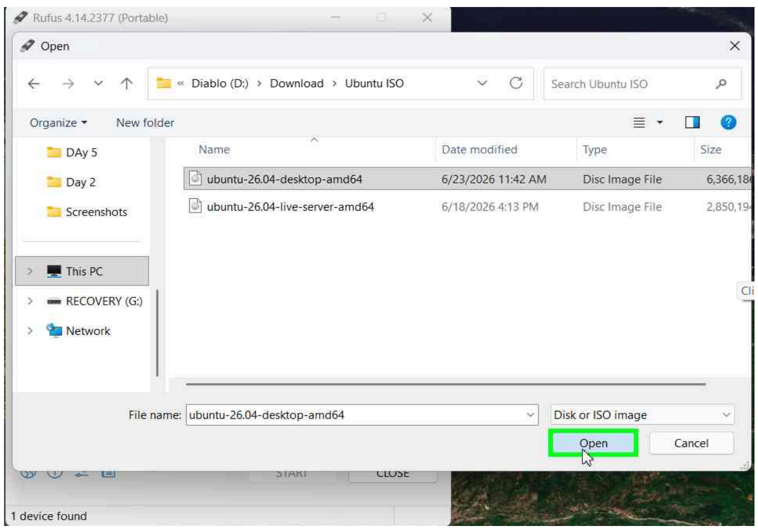
Creating a Bootable USB Drive with Rufus

Step 1: Select the Ubuntu ISO File

Open Rufus. In the file picker dialog, navigate to the folder containing your Ubuntu ISO files. Select ubuntu-26.04-desktop-amd64 (the desktop edition) and click Open.

- Ensure you pick the correct ISO — desktop edition for a full graphical Ubuntu install



Step 2: Rufus Loads the ISO (Overview)

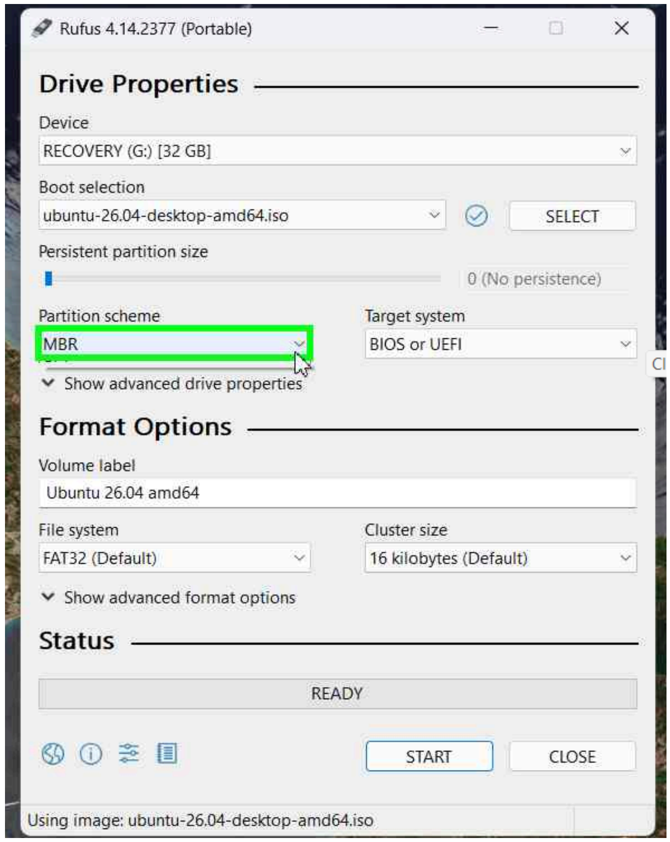
After selecting the ISO, Rufus auto-populates the Boot selection field. You can now see the Drive Properties panel with the default settings loaded.

- Device is set to RECOVERY (G:) — the 32 GB USB drive
- Partition scheme defaults to MBR — this needs to be changed for modern UEFI systems

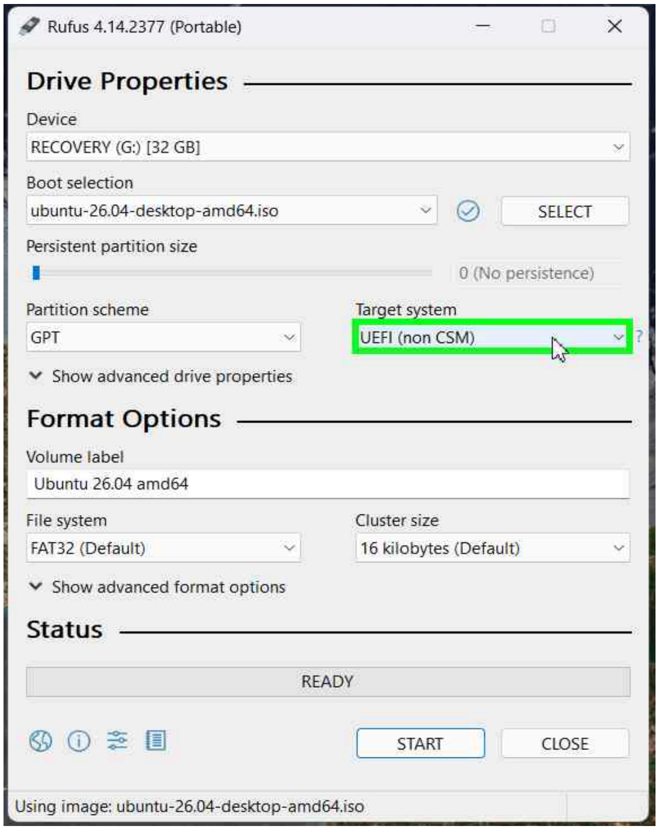
Step 3: Change the Partition Scheme

By default, Rufus selects MBR as the partition scheme with Target system set to BIOS or UEFI. For modern laptops with UEFI firmware, you should switch this to GPT.

- MBR works on older BIOS-based systems with up to 4 primary partitions
- GPT can have up to 128 primary partitions
- Click the Partition scheme dropdown to change it



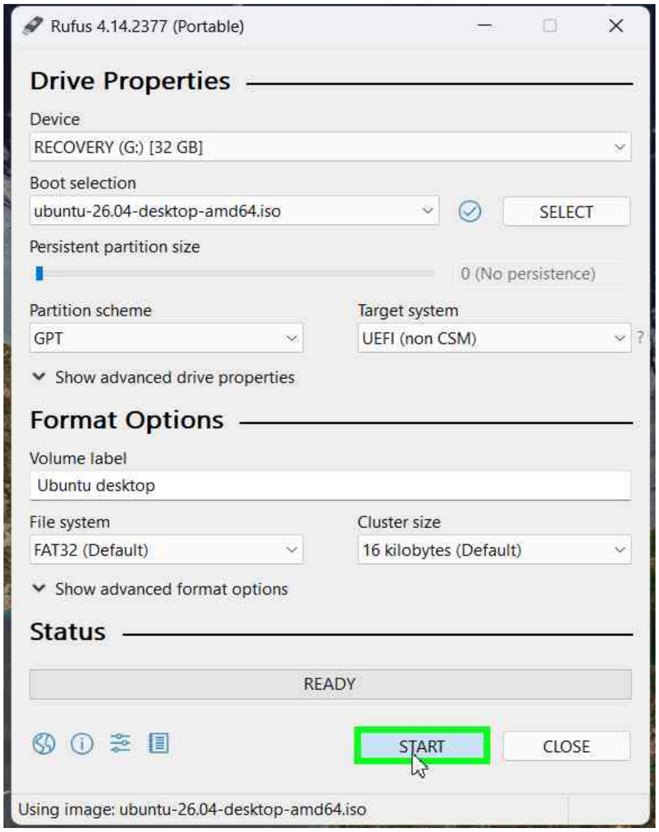
- GPT (GUID Partition Table) is required for UEFI boot without CSM/Legacy support
- Once GPT is selected, the “Target system” will automatically update to UEFI (non CSM)
- This ensures maximum compatibility with Secure Boot and modern firmware
- UEFI (non CSM) means the USB will only boot in pure UEFI mode — no legacy fallback
- File system remains FAT32 (Default) — this is required for UEFI bootable USB drives



Step 4: Click START to Begin Writing

Review all settings one final time, then click the START button. Rufus will begin writing the Ubuntu ISO to the USB drive.

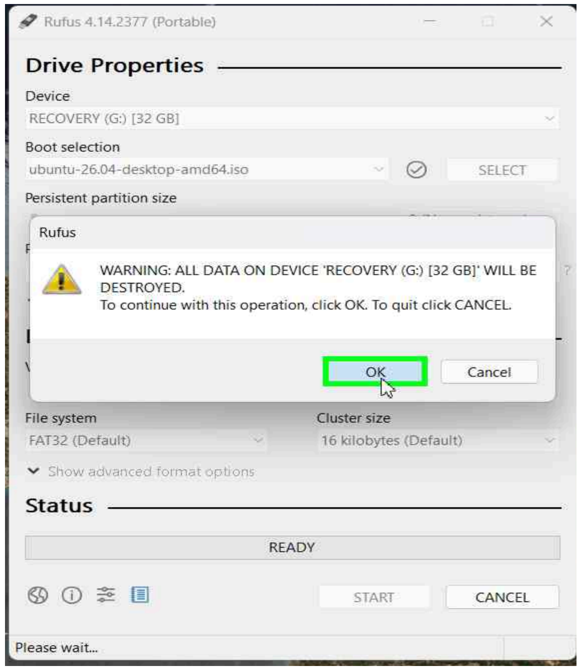
- Partition scheme: GPT
- Target system: UEFI (non CSM)
- File system: FAT32 (Default)
- Volume label: Ubuntu desktop
- Status shows READY — the drive is ready to be written



Step 5: Confirm Data Destruction Warning

Rufus displays a final warning: ALL DATA ON DEVICE RECOVERY (G:) [32 GB] WILL BE DESTROYED. Click OK to confirm and begin the write process.

- This is your last chance to cancel — click Cancel if you are unsure
- Once you click OK, the USB drive is wiped and the ISO is written
- The write process typically takes 15-20 minutes depending on USB speed
- Do not remove the USB drive until Rufus shows READY in the Status bar



Bootable Ubuntu USB drive is now ready